

Verizon PM Interview Prep

Telecom domain primer + Verizon business context + sample case answers

1. Verizon — Facts to Know Cold

- Two reportable segments: **Consumer Group (VCG)** and **Business Group (VBG)**.
- **Frontier acquisition** completed Jan 20, 2026 — major fiber footprint expansion.
- **Churn** is a recurring earnings-call theme; postpaid churn is elevated, FWA churn is under 1%.
- **FWA (Fixed Wireless Access)** is the low-cost growth engine for rural/suburban broadband.
- CEO **Daniel Schulman's** priorities: customer-centricity, churn reduction, disciplined/profitable growth.
- 2026 reporting change: revenue now split into **Mobility & Broadband Service**, **Wireless Equipment**, and **Other** revenue — emphasis on recurring service revenue.
- Competitive pressure: T-Mobile/AT&T; promo pricing; satellite-to-cell entrants (e.g. Starlink) threaten the rural coverage advantage.

2. Acronym Glossary

Short form	Full form
VCG	Verizon Consumer Group
VBG	Verizon Business Group
FWA	Fixed Wireless Access
ARPU	Average Revenue Per User
ARPA	Average Revenue Per Account
CAC	Customer Acquisition Cost
NPS	Net Promoter Score
EBITDA	Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
MEC	Multi-access Edge Computing
IoT	Internet of Things
SDN	Software-Defined Network
LTE	Long-Term Evolution (the '4G' standard)
mmWave	Millimeter Wave (high-band 5G spectrum)
Fios	Fiber Optic Service (Verizon's fiber brand)
SMB	Small and Medium-sized Business
FCC	Federal Communications Commission
OSS	Operations Support Systems

Short form	Full form
BSS	Business Support Systems
MVNO	Mobile Virtual Network Operator
RICE	Reach, Impact, Confidence, Effort (prioritization framework)

3. Telecom Domain — The End-to-End Flow

Walkthrough example: a customer signs up for a new Verizon phone plan.

Step	Stage	System	What happens
1	Order Placement	BSS	Customer buys a plan (app/store). Hits CRM (stores customer profile) and Order Management
2	Provisioning	OSS	Network elements are configured: SIM activated, phone number assigned, SIM linked to the
3	Network Delivery	Network	Phone connects to nearest tower over a spectrum band (e.g. mid-band C-band 5G). Data tra
4	Usage Tracking	BSS	Network usage is reported back via mediation: raw usage records are translated into billable
5	Billing	BSS	Usage records feed the billing engine, which applies plan rules (overages, family-plan splits,
6	Customer Care	OSS + BSS	If something breaks (bad signal, wrong charge), support pulls from OSS (is there an outage r

One-line summary: BSS (order) → OSS (provision) → Network (deliver) → BSS (bill) → Care (support, pulls from both) — this loop repeats every billing cycle.

Quick definitions: **OSS** (Operations Support Systems) = runs the network (provisioning, fault management, inventory). **BSS** (Business Support Systems) = runs the business (billing, CRM, order management, care). A telecom PM usually lives in BSS unless working directly on network engineering products.

4. Core Telecom Concepts

Network generations

Gen	What it enabled
2G	Voice + SMS
3G	Mobile data, basic internet
4G / LTE	Broadband-speed mobile data, streaming
5G	Low latency (1-10ms), high device density, network slicing

Spectrum bands

- **Low-band** — long range, weak indoor penetration, slower speeds.
- **Mid-band (C-band)** — balance of range and speed; Verizon's current 5G workhorse.
- **High-band (mmWave)** — ultra-fast, very short range; stadiums/dense urban areas.

Other key concepts

- **Latency** — delay between request and response; critical for gaming, autonomous vehicles, remote surgery.
- **Network slicing** — virtually partitioning one physical 5G network into logical networks for different use cases.
- **Edge computing / MEC** — processing data near the user instead of a distant data center, to cut latency.
- **Fixed Wireless Access (FWA)** — delivering home internet over cellular signal instead of running fiber/cable.

- **Postpaid vs Prepaid** — postpaid: monthly billing, higher ARPU, credit check required. Prepaid: pay upfront, serves credit-constrained customers.
- **MVNO** — a company reselling network capacity it doesn't own (e.g. Mint Mobile on T-Mobile's network).
- **Churn** — % of customers leaving in a period; the most-watched telecom metric.

5. FWA — Explained Simply

Normal home internet (Fios, cable) needs a physical wire run into your house. FWA skips that: you get a small router/box that talks to the nearest cell tower the same way your phone does — using cellular signal instead of a buried cable. It's like a giant phone sitting on your shelf, pulling data from the tower.

Why it matters for Verizon: no trenches, no cable runs — just decent cell coverage and a box shipped to the customer. Cheap and fast to deploy, especially in rural/suburban areas where fiber would be very expensive.

The catch: since it depends on signal strength like a phone, box placement in the home really matters (near a window, away from walls/metal). Bad placement = bad internet, even with good network coverage in the area.

6. Sample PM Case Study — Improving FWA Install Experience

Problem statement

FWA has Verizon's lowest churn (<1%) of any product line. The biggest threat: self-install failure — a customer plugs the box in somewhere convenient (not signal-optimal), gets weak speeds, assumes the product is bad, and cancels within the first month. Preventable loss, not a real network limitation.

Goal

Reduce 30-day cancellation rate for new FWA installs, without adding cost (no truck rolls/technician visits — that would defeat FWA's cost advantage).

User segments

- Tech-comfortable self-installers (majority)
- Less tech-comfortable customers needing more hand-holding
- Rural customers near the edge of coverage, where placement matters even more

Proposed solution

- **Pre-order signal confidence check** — customer enters address, sees a realistic predicted speed range (not just eligible/not eligible). Sets honest expectations upfront.
- **Guided in-box setup wizard** — app walks them through finding a strong-signal spot with a live signal-strength meter, before they commit to wiring the rest of the house.

Success metrics

- Primary: 30-day cancellation rate for new installs (before/after)
- Secondary: % of installs requiring a follow-up support call about speed/signal
- Guardrail: order-to-activation time does not increase

Trade-off to flag

The pre-order signal check may scare off some borderline-eligible customers at checkout — a short-term hit to gross adds in exchange for a long-term churn win. Worth it, since a 30-day churned customer wastes CAC, while a customer who never signs up costs nothing.

7. Other Improvement Ideas (quick-reference)

- **Early churn-risk signal** — flag risk before a cancel click (e.g. 2 billing support calls in a month).
- **Billing transparency** — auto-explain 'why is my bill different this month' (proration, plan changes).
- **Frontier integration experience** — unified onboarding/migration UX for ex-Frontier customers post-acquisition.
- **Simplify plan choice** — guided 3-question flow to recommend one plan instead of overwhelming options.
- **Proactive outage communication** — in-app banner with ETA tied to the customer's specific tower/area.

8. Additional Case Studies

Use the same structure in interviews: Problem → Goal → Segments → Solution → Metrics → Trade-off. Below are condensed versions for quick recall.

Case Study A — My Verizon App: Reducing Support Call Volume

Problem: A large share of avoidable support calls (billing confusion, plan questions, basic troubleshooting) could be self-served in-app, but aren't — driving up cost-to-serve.

Goal: Increase % of issues resolved in-app without a support contact, without hurting app NPS or burying users in self-service dead-ends.

Segments: Postpaid mobile, FWA/home internet, small business — each has different top issues.

- **Proactive bill-shock alerts** — notify before overage charges hit, with a one-tap option to add data.
- **FWA self-serve diagnostics** — signal check, router restart flow, expected resolution time, before routing to a live agent.
- **Contextual help** — surface the right help article/flow based on what's actually happening on the account (e.g. a bill spike triggers a 'why did my bill change' card automatically).

Metrics: % of issues resolved in-app (vs. baseline call volume), app NPS, repeat-contact rate for the same issue.

Trade-off: heavier in-app guidance can slow down power users who just want a quick task done — needs a fast 'skip to agent' escape hatch.

Case Study B — Predictive Churn Intervention

Problem: Most retention offers trigger only after a customer starts the cancellation flow — too late; intent to leave usually builds for weeks before that.

Goal: Reduce voluntary postpaid churn by intervening earlier, without training customers to expect a discount just for complaining.

- Build a churn-risk score from leading signals: repeat billing support contacts, declining app usage, competitor store visits (if inferable), price-plan downgrades.
- Route high-risk accounts to a tailored retention action — not always a discount; sometimes a plan fit fix, a loyalty perk, or a proactive 'we noticed an issue' outreach.

Metrics: Voluntary churn rate, save-rate on intervened accounts vs. control group, retention offer cost per saved account. **Trade-off:** false positives create noise/cost; needs an A/B-tested control group to prove causality, not just correlation.

Case Study C — Post-Acquisition Experience (Frontier)

Problem: After the Frontier acquisition, ex-Frontier customers face different apps, billing systems, and support lines than legacy Verizon customers — a common source of post-merger churn.

Goal: Migrate ex-Frontier customers onto a unified Verizon experience with minimal disruption and no spike in churn during the transition window.

- Phased migration with clear in-app/email communication of what's changing and when.
- Temporary support team trained specifically on legacy Frontier issues during the transition.
- Price/plan protection guarantee for a defined period so customers don't feel the merger as a price hike.

Metrics: Churn rate of migrated cohort vs. legacy base, support ticket volume during transition, migration completion rate. **Trade-off:** moving fast reduces dual-running costs but raises disruption risk; moving slow protects experience but delays cost synergies leadership is expecting.

Prepared as personal interview prep notes — verify any time-sensitive figures (subscriber counts, exact churn %, leadership) closer to interview date.